

They Never End

There are countless programs available to you. Open an Individual Development Account, a special kind of savings account. For every dollar you put in, the government puts in a dollar, and a private group puts in a dollar. It triples your investment! The money can be used to buy a house, go to school, or start a business; whatever you want! Contact www.idanetwork.org.

If you live near a university or medical college, you can often get your health check-ups, eye exams, and dental visits for free! If not free, they will be at a much cheaper rate. To find a dental college, contact: www.adea.org; to find an eye doctor school, contact www.aoa.org.

Your local community may have programs to help you with after school care, or taking care of your elderly parents, or even substance abuse. For free care and information, contact www.salvationarmyusa.org or www.catholiccharitiesusa.org.

One of the most crippling expenses facing many people today is prescription medicines. There are assistance programs available that can save you hundreds, perhaps thousands, of dollars! Usually you will need your doctor's involvement. Contact www.helpingpatients.org.

That's Not All, Folks

Many county government offices offer programs for first-time home buyers. You can literally save thousands. Programs vary widely, so contact your local office. There are also programs for homeowners who get caught in a temporary situation and cannot make their house payment. To see if your area gives aid to get you through a bind, contact www.hud.gov/offices/. If you live in a rural area, there are programs to help you fix up your house, pay your rent, or even purchase a house. Contact www.rurdev.usda.gov.

It may be the American dream to own a home; the government launched a grant program in 2004 called the American Dream Downpayment Act. This is not a reduced loan; this is your actual down payment. You have to be a first-time buyer to qualify and there is an income limitation. See <http://www.hud.gov/offices/cpd/affordablehousing/programs/home/addi/> for more information.